BRANNDON COELHO

Application ArchitectTechinical LeadSenior Software Engineer

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ABOUT BRANNDON

I'm a seasoned **software engineer** with over 15 years of professional experience. My journey began with driving the IT evolution at **The Penny Hoarder** from its inception to a recognized media giant. My tenure there saw the orchestration of **critical business applications**, site optimizations that decreased load times from **2.7 seconds to 0.89**, and the designing of a **machine learning-based email content recommendation system**.

Currently at **Headspace**, I've refined my expertise in **Django-based application development**, ensuring **scalable** and **security-focused software architecture**. This involves not only technical tasks but also **mentoring junior engineers**, guiding software architecture, and ensuring adherence to industry's best practices. My commitment to technology is evident as I keep pace with **Django framework enhancements** and implement them for innovative solutions.

Beyond my technical prowess, I've played a pivotal role in transforming a startup from **$4 million to $40 million** in annual revenue, scaling the team from a mere 10 to over **100**. A true believer in **continuous learning** and **adaptability**, I align my strategic and activator strengths to achieve impeccable results in fast-paced environments.

[1] My top 5 professional strengths in order are:

- Strategic
- Activator
- Individualization
- Achiever
- Adaptability

Source: Gallup/Clifton Strengths Finder https://www.gallup.com/cliftonstrengths/en/252137/home.aspx

WORK EXPERIENCE

Work experience dating back to 2007: https://branndon.dev/linkedin

Senior Software Engineer

Headspace

2022 - Present

At Headspace, I've excelled in the end-to-end development of Django-based applications, ensuring optimized ORM querying, scalable middleware integration, and robust migration management. I've been instrumental in in guiding the software architecture, focusing on modular design, scalability, and security.

Beyond Django, my role involves leading exploratory projects with best practices like CI/CD, TDD, and agile methodologies. I actively mentor junior engineers, promote code reviews, and ensure adherence to Django and industry-wide best practices.

Tasked with project segments, I work closely with cross-functional teams, emphasizing DRY principles, RESTful API design, and Django-specific performance tuning. I remain committed to staying updated with the Django framework enhancements and integrating them for innovative solutions.

Achievements:

- Architected and delivered Django projects with a focus on performance, security, and scalability.
- Championed the implementation of CI/CD pipelines, ensuring streamlined deployments and integrations.
- Mentored junior engineers, emphasizing Django best practices and effective ORM utilization.
- Facilitated rigorous code reviews, reinforcing coding standards and efficient design patterns.

- Crafted comprehensive software documentation, promoting clarity and ease-of-use for ongoing Django projects.
- Efficiently coordinated with diverse teams, ensuring clear communication of technical decisions and Django-centric solutions.

Technologies Touched (in order of usage):

Django JWT Auth0 Docker Braze Jira Confluence Atlassian Asana Lucid Charts Figma Software Architecture APIs CI/CD TDD ORM RESTful API Agile

Senior Software Engineer - Backend Focus

Webley Systems

2020 - 2021

Spearheaded the development of a scalable backend infrastructure at Webley Systems, utilizing Python's advanced features like decorators and context managers. Employing Flask for our RESTful API, I architected an AWS-integrated backend to handle streaming video compilation. Collaborating within a high-caliber team, I honed my skills in Test Driven Development, Python Unittest, and seamlessly interfaced a Single Page Application (SPA) frontend using React with our Python backend.

Achievements:

- Achieved proficiency in Flask and embraced TDD principles through dedicated training sessions.
- Engineered a custom automation system reminiscent of GIT, revolutionizing a two-decade-old manual ticketing process. This innovative tool bridged updates between the legacy CMS and Slack channels via headless Selenium, demonstrating a blend of autonomy and technical acumen.
- Ensured robust software delivery by authoring comprehensive tests for both legacy systems and new implementations.
- Autonomously designed a standalone API infrastructure leveraging AWS services like Lambda, API Gateway, and ALB. This system adeptly managed fragmented video segments, amalgamating them to deliver cohesive streaming content to end-users.

Technologies Touched (in order of usage):

API Python Flask TDD Slack Selenium Git via Github AWS EC2 AWS S3 AWS Lambda AWS API Gateway AWS Route53 JavaScript CSS Decorators Context Managers

Application Architect / Lead Developer / Senior Developer

The Penny Hoarder

2014 - 2020

Began at The Penny Hoarder in 2014 through a consulting agency, transitioning to a full-time role in Florida by 2015, reflecting adaptability during the company's early stages.

Played a key role in the evolution of the IT department, starting as its sole member and subsequently contributing to the hiring of roles including IT Director, Lead Developer, DevOps Engineer, QA Lead, and Scrum Master.

Drove the design and deployment of critical business applications, such as administrative dashboards and automated reporting. Steered the direction and execution of the entire software ecosystem.

Contributed to team growth by leading weekly code reviews, mentoring developers, and collaborating with both executive staff and project management to align technical and business goals.

Achievements:

- **Application Architect**
  - Optimized site load time from 2.7 seconds to 0.89 seconds, resulting in significant cost savings and revenue increase.
  - Designed a machine learning-based email content recommendation system.
  - Assumed a lead role during emergency scenarios, deploying hotfixes and addressing production issues.
  - Ensured company growth in 2017/2018 by upholding coding standards and optimizing software architecture.

- **Lead Developer**
  - Contributed to the recognition of The Penny Hoarder by Inc. 500 in 2016 and 2017 as a rapidly growing private media company.
  - Oversaw a significant site performance initiative, transitioning from AWS Cloudfront to Cloudflare, enhancing the site's scalability under heavy loads.

- **Senior Developer**
  - Implemented a robust and scalable WordPress setup with a focus on performance and maintainability.
  - Collaborated closely with the CEO during a comprehensive site migration to Amazon Web Services.

- Took active part in technology roadmapping and strategic discussions.

Technologies Touched (in order of usage):

Python API WordPress JavaScript PHP Git via Github Docker AWS EC2 MySQL Flask Node.js Redis Nginx CSS PostgresSQL AWS Lambda AWS S3 AWS RDS AWS API Gateway AWS Route53 AWS Aurora Cloudflare AWS CloudFront AWS Code Pipeline Vue.js

RECOMMENDATIONS

Additional recommendations:https://branndon.dev/linkedin

Kyle Taylor

CEO | The Penny Hoarder

https://www.linkedin.com/in/kylebradleytaylor

I've been lucky enough to work alongside Branndon for nearly two years now and while he's always been a pleasure to work with, I feel like this year in particular has brought about a huge transformation. He has a growing confidence in his skills and abilities and it's been such a pleasure to watch him realize his own talent.

Stephen McDermott

IT Director | The Penny Hoarder

https://linkedin.com/in/stephencmcdermott

The code looks to be easily maintainable and modular. I have noticed that when creating deliverables, regression testing is relatively isolated. A poorly coded site would include multiple cross dependencies, whereas one change would result in changes across the whole system. Branndon has coded a good portion of this site and it is built well.

Jennifer Franko

Scrum Master II | The Penny Hoarder

https://www.linkedin.com/in/jenniferfranko

Branndon is one of the most well rounded, patient and talented developers I have had the pleasure to work with. Branndon is always thinking of the user experience as he works on his outstanding coding. Branndon never shows signs of stress and was always able to successfully complete any tasks with favorable results despite deadline pressure. His technical skill is outstanding but he also has the ability to communicate clearly and to collaborate effectively.

Branndon is a rare find within the development world as he is constantly furthering his knowledge and skills. He repetitively amazed me with his industry insight and original approaches to solving problems.

Branndon always takes the time to provide technical guidance and mentorship to his fellow developers. Branndon leads by example and people find his enthusiasm and dedication both inspiring and motivating.

Branndon is dedicated, self-motivated, methodical, and very capable. I thoroughly enjoyed working with him at The Penny Hoarder and hope that one day I will have the privilege to work with him again. He is a true Rock Star!!!

FUN FACTS

Built a Custom 4x4

2005 - 2006

Being a self-learner, I rebuilt an entire 4x4 truck. This project involved a complete teardown and rebuild of the engine, transmission, transfer cases, paint stripping, repainting and axles. I accomplished this without formal training, using only the early internet as my guide.

Lived in an RV for 3 years

2012 - 2015

My family and I lived in an RV for three years, traveling across the country while I worked in web development to pay the bills. This phase ended in 2015 when Kyle Taylor of The Penny Hoarder offered to relocate my family to St. Petersburg, FL, where I took on the role of Sr. Developer in-house.

Created my own Job

2012 - 2015

During meetings with a recent web client, I heard them mention the lack of on-site IT support; instead, they relied on a local vendor. As I was looking for an in-house position, I drafted a proposal highlighting the need for a web developer and the benefits of hiring me. Shortly after, they appointed me as the IT Manager. My responsibilities included onboarding new clients, creating EDI and FTP systems to exchange data with clients, and integrating legacy systems with newer PHP-based systems.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Frontend

HTML/CSS (Very Strong)
JavaScript (Very Strong)
React.js (Some Experience)

Backend

Python (Strong)
Django (Very Strong)
Node.js (Very Strong)
Docker (Strong)
Linux (Good)

Other

Automation (Strong)
DevOps (Strong)
Git (Very Strong)
WordPress (Very Strong)